

Schemes, Institutions and the Current Dossier

Chapter F10.2 — The Perishable Content, Dated and Sourced, To Be Re-Verified Before the Paper

Module	Foundation Layer — Module 10 — Integrated Current Affairs
Chapter	Chapter F10.2
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IMPORTANT · READ F10.1 §4 BEFORE YOU MEMORISE ANYTHING HERE

Every figure in this chapter is stated **as at 16 August 2026** and carries a source link. **Some of them will have changed by the time you sit the paper.**

F10.1 §4 gives the twelve-item verification sweep, to be run in the **fortnight before** the examination. Run it. A figure from this chapter that you have not re-checked is a figure you should not carry into the hall, for the reason F10.1 §4.1 sets out: under the marking scheme a confident stale answer costs **-0.8333**, while a blank costs **nothing**.

What will not change is the material in §1 and §2 about *what replaced what and from when*. Statutes and schemes that have come into force do not un-come into force. **That is where the marks in this chapter actually are**, and it is why they come first.

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0. How This Chapter Works

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F10.2

1. **Session 1** — The four labour codes (§1) ★★★★★
2. **Session 2** — The EPFO dossier (§2) ★★★★★
3. **Session 3** — The economy dossier (§3) ★★★★★
4. **Session 4** — Demography and the social sector (§4) ★★★★★

Then 30 graded questions in §5. Budget **two evenings**, and give §1 and §2 the larger share — they are directly on the subject matter of the post you are applying for.

§3 deliberately **cross-refers to Module 4 rather than repeating it**. The economy figures are set out in F4.1 §3.1, F4.2 §2.3 and §3.3, and F4.3 §2.2; §3 here gives only the consolidated list for the sweep.

1. Session 1 — The Four Labour Codes ★★★★★

1.1 The central fact

HIGH YIELD · IN FORCE FROM 21 NOVEMBER 2025, REPLACING 29 CENTRAL ACTS [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]

Code	Year of enactment
Code on Wages	2019
Industrial Relations Code	2020
Code on Social Security	2020
Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code	2020

All four were **brought into force with effect from 21 November 2025**, and they **replace 29 central labour laws**. The **central rules** giving them full effect were notified in 2026, the Government having considered objections to the draft rules published in December 2025.

Sources: The Hindu on operationalisation and the 29 Acts · Economic Times on the commencement date · EY alert on the codes taking effect

Note the gap between enactment and commencement. The Code on Wages was passed in **2019** and came into force in **2025** — six years later. A question giving a *year* is probably asking about enactment; a question giving a *date* is asking about commencement. F10.1 §7's second shape. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

1.2 Which Acts went into which code

Code	Principal Acts subsumed
Code on Wages, 2019	Payment of Wages Act 1936, Minimum Wages Act 1948 , Payment of Bonus Act 1965, Equal Remuneration Act 1976
Industrial Relations Code, 2020	Industrial Disputes Act 1947 , Trade Unions Act 1926, Industrial Employment (Standing Orders) Act 1946
Code on Social Security, 2020	Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act 1952 , ESI Act 1948, Payment of Gratuity Act 1972 , Maternity Benefit Act 1961, Employees' Compensation Act 1923
OSH Code, 2020	Factories Act 1948 , Mines Act 1952, Contract Labour Act 1970, Inter-State Migrant Workmen Act 1979

MUST MASTER · THE ONE THAT MATTERS MOST TO THIS POST

The Employees' Provident Funds and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 is subsumed into the Code on Social Security, 2020. So is the ESI Act, gratuity, maternity benefit and workmen's compensation.

That single mapping is the most examinable fact in this session for an APFC candidate, because it means the statute the post is built on now sits inside a code. **Four Acts to remember per code, and the social security code's four are the ones to know cold.**

Two definitional changes worth holding:

1. **A uniform definition of "wages" applies across all four codes** — previously each Act defined it differently, which is what produced decades of litigation over what counted for provident fund purposes. This is the change with the largest practical effect on EPFO administration
2. **"Gig worker" and "platform worker" are now statutory categories**, defined for the first time — §2.5

1.3 Gig and platform workers under the Code on Social Security

HIGH YIELD · THE AGGREGATOR'S OBLIGATION [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]

Feature	Provision
Aggregator's contribution	Between 1% and 2% of annual turnover, subject to a ceiling of 5% of the amount paid to gig and platform workers
Registration of workers	Aggregators must upload worker details to a central portal within 45 days
Interest on delayed contributions	12% per annum
Record-keeping	Real-time recording of engagements and exits
Eligibility (draft rules)	Engagement of not less than 90 days with one aggregator, or 120 days across multiple aggregators, in the last financial year

Sources: Livemint on the 1–2% turnover formula · Economic Times on the 45-day registration and 12% interest · Livemint on the 90/120-day eligibility condition

Why the contribution is on TURNOVER rather than on wages is the conceptual point, and it is the same one F8.3's fourth passage makes: a platform worker has no wage an employer can be made to contribute against, so the levy attaches to the only reliably identifiable base — the platform's revenue. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

1. Name the four codes with their years of enactment and the date they came into force
2. How many central Acts did they replace?
3. Which code subsumed the EPF Act 1952? Name the other three Acts in that code
4. Which code subsumed the Industrial Disputes Act? The Factories Act?
5. Give the aggregator's contribution formula and its ceiling
6. State the two definitional changes that matter most

2. Session 2 — The EPFO Dossier ★★★★★

2.1 The interest rate

KNOW · 8.25% FOR 2025-26 [AS AT 16 AUG 2026] · SWEEP ITEM 5

Item	Reading
EPF interest rate, 2025-26	8.25%
Recommended by	The Central Board of Trustees , at its meeting of 28 February 2026
Ratified by	The Government (Finance Ministry concurrence), June 2026
Consecutive years at this rate	Third
Contributing members	over 7 crore
CBT chaired by	Mansukh Mandaviya , Union Minister for Labour and Employment

Sources: Economic Times on ratification · The Hindu · Livemint on the CBT recommendation

The durable point, which survives any change in the rate: the rate is **recommended by the CBT and takes effect only on ratification by the Government**. A question asking *who declares the EPF interest rate* is asking about that two-step process, not about the number. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.2 The wage ceiling — a proposal, not yet law

TRAP · THE CEILING IS STILL ₹15,000. THE ₹25,000 FIGURE IS A PROPOSAL [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]

This is the item most likely to be got wrong, because the proposed figure has been widely reported and reads like a decided fact.

Item	Position
Statutory wage ceiling for mandatory EPF coverage	₹15,000 a month — unchanged since 2014
Mandatory employee contribution at the ceiling	₹1,800 a month (12% of ₹15,000); contributions above that are voluntary
The proposal	The Department of Expenditure has approved a proposal to raise the ceiling to ₹25,000, subject to Cabinet approval and notification
Status	Not yet in effect
Background	The Supreme Court asked the Government to reassess the ₹15,000 limit, unchanged since 2014

Sources: Livemint on the Department of Expenditure approval · Economic Times on the ₹1,800 cap and voluntary excess · Economic Times on the Supreme Court direction

The discipline this teaches is general and worth more than the fact. Current affairs reporting does not distinguish clearly between **proposed, approved, notified and in force**, and an examiner does. Four stages:

proposed » approved by a department » Cabinet approval » notified and in force

Only the last is law. Whenever you record a change in your monthly sheet (F10.1 §3.2), **write which of the four stages it has reached.** Q27 turns on exactly this. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.3 The Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026

HIGH YIELD · EPS 2026 HAS REPLACED EPS-95 [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]

Feature	Position
New scheme	Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026, effective 29 June 2026
What it replaced	EPS-95 (and the older EPS-71 family scheme arrangements)
Unchanged	The pension formula and the contribution structure
Minimum monthly pension	₹1,000 — unchanged, and in force since 1 September 2014
New: claim settlement	Pension claims to be settled within 20 days
New: penalty on the EPFO	12% interest payable where the EPFO delays
Omitted	The sub-paragraph giving a one-year window to opt to contribute on salary above the ceiling
Higher pension option	Arises from the Supreme Court's judgment of 4 November 2022 ; applications still being processed

Sources: Economic Times on EPS 2026 replacing EPS-95 · Economic Times on the ₹1,000 minimum being unchanged · The Hindu on the omitted higher-pension clause

Two things to be precise about, because both are widely misreported:

1. **The minimum pension has NOT been increased.** It remains **₹1,000**, as it has since 2014, despite sustained demands for ₹7,500. An option asserting an increase is wrong
2. **The formula has not changed.** EPS 2026 is largely a **consolidation and a service-standards reform** — the 20-day settlement and the 12% penalty on the EPFO are the substantive novelties

Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.

2.4 EPFO 3.0

Feature	Position [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]
What it is	The EPFO's digital overhaul — UPI and UPI-enabled ATM withdrawals
Auto-settlement limit	Raised to ₹5 lakh , from ₹1 lakh
Withdrawable through UPI	Up to 75% of the EPF balance
Withdrawal categories	13 simplified to 3
Other features	Automatic account transfer on changing jobs; reduced employer dependency for most claims

Sources: ClearTax on EPFO 3.0 · Livemint on the 75% limit and portal upgrade

The connection worth making — and a strong interview answer — is that EPFO 3.0 is the **provident fund's version of the JAM architecture** in F4.2 §4.3. Settlement times fell because the **payment rails** changed, not because the statute did. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

2.5 The Employment Linked Incentive Scheme

Feature	Position [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]
Outlay	about ₹99,446 crore
Effective from	1 August 2025
Part A — first-time employees	One month's EPF wage, up to ₹15,000, paid in two instalments
Instalment timing	After 6 months and after 12 months of service
Condition on the second instalment	Completion of a financial literacy programme
Eligibility	Monthly salary up to ₹1 lakh
Part B — employers	Up to ₹3,000 a month for two years per additional employee

Sources: PIB on the ELI Scheme · Economic Times on the outlay and structure

Why it matters to this post: the scheme is **delivered through EPFO registration**, which makes the EPFO an instrument of employment policy and not only of social security. *Content rephrased from the sources for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

1. Give the EPF interest rate for 2025-26 and the two-step process by which it takes effect
2. What is the wage ceiling **now**, and what is the proposal, and what stage has it reached?
3. What replaced EPS-95, from when, and what did **not** change?
4. Give the auto-settlement limit and the UPI withdrawal proportion under EPFO 3.0
5. Give the ELI Scheme's benefit, its two instalment conditions, and the salary eligibility

3. Session 3 — The Economy Dossier ★★★★★

The figures are set out with their sources in Module 4. This section is the **consolidated sweep list** so that §4 of F10.1 can be run from one page.

Item	Reading [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]	Detail in
GDP growth 2025-26	7.4% (First Advance Estimates); about 7.6% on the revised series	F4.1 §3.1
GDP base year	Revised from 2011-12 to 2022-23	F4.1 §2.3
Growth projection 2026-27	6.8% to 7.2%	F4.1 §3.1
Repo rate	5.25% , unchanged, neutral stance, 62nd MPC (3–5 Aug 2026)	F4.2 §2.3
SDF / MSF and Bank Rate	5.00% / 5.50%	F4.2 §2.3
CPI inflation 2025-26	about 2.1% ; 2026-27 Q1 and Q2 near 4.0% and 4.2%	F4.2 §3.3
Fiscal deficit	4.3% of GDP (2026-27 BE); 4.4% (2025-26 RE)	F4.3 §2.2
Total expenditure / capex	about ₹53.5 lakh crore / about ₹12.2 lakh crore	F4.3 §2.2
GST slabs	5% and 18% , plus a 40% de-merit rate, from 22 Sept 2025	F4.3 §3.2
Income tax statute	Income-tax Act, 2025 , in force 1 April 2026	F4.3 §3.3
Finance Commission	16th, Panagariya, 2026–31, share 41%	F4.3 §4.1
Unemployment rate / LFPR	about 5.1% / about 54–55%	F4.4 §2.2
Total fertility rate	below replacement — 1.9 (SRS) / 2.0 (NFHS-6)	F4.5 §1.3
Census 2027	First digital census; reference date 1 March 2027 ; caste included	F4.5 §2.3

KNOW · THE SIX ITEMS FROM THIS LIST MOST LIKELY TO APPEAR

If you had to reduce the economy dossier to six facts, these are the six — chosen because each is **definite, recent, and contradicts material printed before 2025**:

1. **GST has two main slabs, 5% and 18% — not four**
2. **The Income-tax Act, 2025 replaced the 1961 Act** on 1 April 2026
3. **The GDP base year is 2022-23 — not 2011-12**
4. **The Sixteenth Finance Commission retained 41% — not 42%**
5. **India's fertility is below replacement level**
6. **Census 2027 is the first digital census and includes caste enumeration**

Every one is a *kind 2* question in F10.1 §1.1's classification — a recent definite change — which is exactly the category with the best ratio of yield to decay.

4. Session 4 — Demography and the Social Sector ★★★★★

4.1 e-Shram and the unorganised sector

Item	Reading [AS AT 16 AUG 2026]
e-Shram registrations	over 30.98 crore unorganised workers
of which platform workers	about 3.37 lakh
Purpose	A national database to make assistance and insurance deliverable to workers with no employer of record

Source: PIB on e-Shram registrations and gig workers

The number worth remembering is the order of magnitude: about 31 crore — set beside the EPFO's roughly 7 crore contributing members, it is the clearest single statement of the coverage gap that the Code on Social Security was written to address. *Content rephrased from the source for compliance with licensing restrictions.*

4.2 The scheme table for quick recall

Scheme	Core fact
Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY	₹5 lakh per family per year
PMJJBY	Life cover ₹2 lakh
PMSBY	Accident cover ₹2 lakh
Atal Pension Yojana	Guaranteed pension ₹1,000 to ₹5,000 a month
MGNREGA	100 days per rural household, a legal guarantee
NFSA, 2013	Subsidised grain as a legal entitlement
PMJDY	Basic bank accounts — the J of JAM
ELI Scheme	One month's EPF wage up to ₹15,000 — \$2.5

TRAP · THE COVER AMOUNTS ARE ALL DIFFERENT AND ALL ROUND NUMBERS

₹5 lakh (PM-JAY, **per family per year**), ₹2 lakh (PMJJBY, **life**), ₹2 lakh (PMSBY, **accident**), ₹1,000–5,000 (APY, **monthly pension**), ₹1,000 (**minimum EPS pension**), ₹5 lakh (**EPFO auto-settlement limit**), ₹15,000 (**EPF wage ceiling** and the **ELI benefit**).

Seven round numbers, and the examiner's whole technique is to attach one to the wrong scheme. Learn each as a triple — **scheme, amount, and unit** — because the unit is what most often distinguishes the right option: PM-JAY's ₹5 lakh is **per family per year**, not per person, and the EPFO's ₹5 lakh is an **auto-settlement threshold**, not a benefit.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 4

1. Give the e-Shram registration figure and set it beside the EPFO's contributing membership
2. Give the cover, and the unit, for PM-JAY, PMJJBY, PMSBY and APY
3. Which two schemes involve a figure of ₹5 lakh, and what does each mean?
4. Which two involve ₹15,000?

5. Graded Practice — 30 Questions ★★★★★

Target: 20 to 30 seconds each. These questions are dated by their nature — re-verify against F10.1 §4 before relying on them close to the paper.

5.1 Level 1 — The codes and the EPFO

Q1. Which one of the four labour codes was enacted earliest? (a) The Industrial Relations Code (b) The Code on Wages (c) The Code on Social Security (d) The Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code

Q2. Under the Code on Social Security, 2020, an aggregator is required to contribute (a) 12% of the wages paid to gig workers (b) a flat ₹1,000 per worker per year (c) between 1% and 2% of its annual turnover, subject to a ceiling of 5% of the amount paid to such workers (d) 8.33% of its annual turnover

Q3. An aggregator must register a gig worker on the designated portal within (a) 45 days (b) 30 days (c) 60 days (d) 90 days

Q4. The rate of interest payable by an aggregator on delayed social security contributions is (a) 6% per annum (b) 8.33% per annum (c) 10% per annum (d) 12% per annum

Q5. The rate of interest declared on Employees' Provident Fund accumulations for 2025-26 is (a) 8.15% (b) 8.10% (c) 8.25% (d) 8.50%

Q6. The rate of interest on provident fund accumulations for a year is (a) recommended by the Central Board of Trustees and takes effect on ratification by the Government (b) fixed by the Reserve Bank of India (c) fixed by the Ministry of Finance alone (d) declared by the Central Provident Fund Commissioner

Q7. The Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026 took effect from (a) 1 April 2026 (b) 29 June 2026 (c) 1 September 2025 (d) 21 November 2025

Q8. Under the Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026, the minimum monthly pension is (a) ₹3,000 (b) ₹5,000 (c) ₹7,500 (d) ₹1,000

Q9. Under the Employees' Pension Scheme, 2026, a pension claim is required to be settled within (a) 7 days (b) 10 days (c) 20 days (d) 45 days

Q10. The statutory wage ceiling for mandatory coverage under the Employees' Provident Fund is at present (a) ₹15,000 a month (b) ₹21,000 a month (c) ₹25,000 a month (d) ₹30,000 a month

5.2 Level 2 — Schemes and the dossier

Q11. The mandatory monthly contribution by an employee at the statutory wage ceiling is (a) ₹1,250 (b) ₹1,500 (c) ₹1,650 (d) ₹1,800

Q12. Under EPFO 3.0, the auto-settlement limit has been raised to (a) ₹1 lakh (b) ₹5 lakh (c) ₹2 lakh (d) ₹10 lakh

Q13. Under EPFO 3.0, a member may withdraw through UPI up to (a) 25% of the balance (b) 50% of the balance (c) 75% of the balance (d) the whole balance

Q14. Under the Employment Linked Incentive Scheme, a first-time employee registered with the EPFO receives (a) one month's EPF wage up to ₹15,000, in two instalments (b) a lump sum of ₹50,000 (c) a pension top-up (d) an interest subsidy on a housing loan

Q15. Under that scheme, the payment of the second instalment is conditional upon (a) completion of three years of service (b) completion of a financial literacy programme (c) the employer's certification of good conduct (d) the employee attaining the age of 25

Q16. Under the Employment Linked Incentive Scheme, a first-time employee is eligible if monthly salary does not exceed (a) ₹15,000 (b) ₹25,000 (c) ₹50,000 (d) ₹1 lakh

Q17. The number of unorganised workers registered on the e-Shram portal is approximately (a) 10 crore (b) 20 crore (c) 31 crore (d) 45 crore

Q18. The restructuring of the Goods and Services Tax into two principal slabs took effect from (a) 22 September 2025 (b) 1 July 2025 (c) 1 April 2026 (d) 1 January 2026

Q19. The Income-tax Act, 2025 came into force on (a) 1 April 2025 (b) 11 August 2025 (c) 1 April 2026 (d) 1 January 2026

Q20. The award period of the Sixteenth Finance Commission is (a) 2025-30 (b) 2026-31 (c) 2027-32 (d) 2021-26

5.3 Level 3 — Recruitment Test standard

Q21. The base year of India's national accounts series has been revised to (a) 2022-23 (b) 2011-12 (c) 2017-18 (d) 2020-21

Q22. The reference date for the population enumeration phase of Census 2027, for the country generally, is (a) 1 January 2027 (b) 1 February 2027 (c) 1 April 2027 (d) 1 March 2027

Q23. Caste enumeration in Census 2027 is to be carried out in (a) Phase I, the houselisting operation (b) a separate third phase (c) Phase II, the population enumeration (d) a sample survey conducted separately

Q24. The policy repo rate, as at the review of August 2026, stood at (a) 6.00% (b) 5.25% (c) 5.50% (d) 4.75%

Q25. India's total fertility rate is now (a) below the replacement level (b) exactly at the replacement level (c) above the replacement level (d) no longer officially measured

Q26. The Periodic Labour Force Survey is now released (a) once every five years (b) annually only (c) quarterly only (d) monthly, as well as quarterly and annually

Q27. Which one of the following statements is **not** correct? (a) The four labour codes replaced 29 central labour laws (b) The minimum pension under the Employees' Pension Scheme has remained ₹1,000 since 2014 (c) The Employees' Provident Fund wage ceiling has been raised to ₹25,000 with effect from 2026 (d) The Employees' Provident Fund interest rate for 2025-26 was retained at 8.25%

Q28. The judgment of the Supreme Court permitting eligible employees to opt for a higher pension under the Employees' Pension Scheme was delivered in (a) November 2022 (b) November 2020 (c) March 2023 (d) July 2019

Q29. The outlay of the Employment Linked Incentive Scheme is approximately (a) ₹50,000 crore (b) ₹99,446 crore (c) ₹2 lakh crore (d) ₹25,000 crore

Q30. For a gig worker engaged with more than one aggregator, the draft rules propose a minimum engagement in the last financial year of (a) 90 days (b) 100 days (c) 110 days (d) 120 days

6. Answers and Explanations

6.1 Level 1

Q	Ans	Explanation
1	b	The Code on Wages, 2019. The other three are of 2020. All four came into force together on 21 November 2025 — so the enactment years differ while the commencement date is common , which is the distinction the question rests on
2	c	1% to 2% of annual turnover , capped at 5% of the amount paid to gig and platform workers. (a) is the EPF rate applied to the wrong base — the whole point is that the levy is on turnover , because there is no wage to levy on
3	a	45 days
4	d	12% per annum — the same rate the EPFO itself must pay for delay under EPS 2026, §2.3
5	c	8.25% , for the third consecutive year
6	a	Recommended by the CBT, effective on Government ratification. This two-step process is the durable fact; the rate itself is a sweep item. (d) confuses the chief executive with the decision-making board — F10.1 §7
7	b	29 June 2026. (d) 21 November 2025 is the labour codes' commencement — two different 2025-26 dates, offered for each other
8	d	₹1,000, unchanged since 1 September 2014. (c) ₹7,500 is the figure long demanded and widely reported, which is why it is the most tempting wrong answer — §2.3
9	c	20 days
10	a	₹15,000, unchanged since 2014. (c) ₹25,000 is the proposal , approved by the Department of Expenditure but not yet notified . §2.2 — proposed is not law

6.2 Level 2

Q	Ans	Explanation
11	d	₹1,800 — 12% of ₹15,000. Contributions above the ceiling are voluntary
12	b	₹5 lakh , raised from ₹1 lakh — so (a) is the superseded figure
13	c	75%
14	a	One month's EPF wage up to ₹15,000, in two instalments — after 6 and 12 months
15	b	Completion of a financial literacy programme — an unusual condition and therefore a good question
16	d	₹1 lakh a month . Note the contrast with (a) ₹15,000, which is the benefit cap , not the eligibility limit — the same number appearing in two roles, which §4.2's trap warns about
17	c	About 31 crore (30.98 crore). Set beside the EPFO's roughly 7 crore contributing members, this is the coverage gap in one comparison
18	a	22 September 2025 , following the 56th GST Council meeting of 3 September 2025
19	c	1 April 2026 . (b) 11 August 2025 is when the Income-Tax (No.2) Bill was introduced — introduction, enactment and commencement are three different dates
20	b	2026-31

6.3 Level 3

Q	Ans	Explanation
21	a	2022-23 , revised from 2011-12
22	d	1 March 2027 . Snow-bound areas have a reference date of 1 October 2026 — F4.5 §2.3
23	c	Phase II, the population enumeration . Phase I is the houselisting and housing census
24	b	5.25% , held unanimously with a neutral stance
25	a	Below replacement — 1.9 on the SRS and 2.0 on NFHS-6, against a replacement level of 2.1. (c) is what almost all older material says
26	d	Monthly , as well as quarterly and annually — a change from the earlier annual design
27	c	The "not correct" item, and the most important question in this bank . The ceiling remains ₹15,000 ; the ₹25,000 figure has departmental approval but has not been notified . (a), (b) and (d) are all correct. §2.2's four stages — proposed, approved, Cabinet-approved, notified — and only the last is law
28	a	4 November 2022
29	b	About ₹99,446 crore
30	d	120 days across multiple aggregators, against 90 days with a single aggregator — so (a) is the single-aggregator figure, and the question turns on reading <i>more than one</i>

THINK LIKE UPSC · THE FOUR SHAPES IN THIS BANK

- 1. Proposed against notified.** Q10 and Q27. **The single most valuable discipline in current affairs**, because reporting blurs the four stages and an examiner does not. When you record a change, record its stage
- 2. The same number in two roles.** Q16 — ₹15,000 is both the ELI **benefit cap** and the EPF **wage ceiling**. Q12 — ₹5 lakh is both PM-JAY's **annual family cover** and EPFO's **auto-settlement threshold**. Learn **scheme, amount and unit** as a triple
- 3. Two adjacent dates.** Q7 (29 June 2026) against the labour codes' 21 November 2025; Q19's three distinct dates for one statute — introduction, enactment, commencement. **Dates cluster in a reform period and are offered for one another**
- 4. The widely demanded figure.** Q8 — ₹7,500 is so often reported as a demand that it reads as a fact. **A number that appears constantly in headlines as an aspiration is a natural distractor**, and the answer is usually the unchanged status quo

7. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F10.2

ALL FIGURES [AS AT 16 AUG 2026] — RUN F10.1 §4's TWELVE-ITEM SWEEP BEFORE THE PAPER

THE FOUR CODES Code on Wages 2019 · IR Code 2020 · Code on Social Security 2020 · OSH Code 2020 · **ALL IN FORCE 21 NOVEMBER 2025** · **replace 29 central Acts** · central rules notified 2026 · **enactment years differ, commencement date is common**

WHICH ACTS WENT WHERE **Wages** » Payment of Wages 1936, Minimum Wages 1948, Bonus 1965, Equal Remuneration 1976 · **IR** » **Industrial Disputes 1947**, Trade Unions 1926, Standing Orders 1946 · **SOCIAL SECURITY** » **EPF ACT 1952**, ESI 1948, **Gratuity 1972**, Maternity Benefit 1961, Employees' Compensation 1923 · **OSH** » **Factories 1948**, Mines 1952, Contract Labour 1970, Inter-State Migrant Workmen 1979

TWO DEFINITIONAL CHANGES a **uniform definition of "wages"** across all four codes · **"gig worker"** and **"platform worker"** are now statutory categories

AGGREGATORS 1–2% of annual turnover, capped at 5% of the amount paid to workers · register workers within **45 days** · **12% a year** interest on delay · real-time records · eligibility **90 days** with one aggregator, **120 days** across several

EPF INTEREST 8.25% for 2025-26, third year running · **recommended by the CBT (28 Feb 2026)**, effective on **GOVERNMENT RATIFICATION** · 7+ crore contributing members · **CBT chaired by the Union Labour Minister**

WAGE CEILING STILL ₹15,000 (since 2014) · mandatory employee contribution **₹1,800**, excess **voluntary** · **₹25,000 is a PROPOSAL** — Department of Expenditure approved, **Cabinet approval and notification pending** · Supreme Court asked for a reassessment · **FOUR STAGES: proposed** » departmentally approved » Cabinet approved » **NOTIFIED**. Only the last is law

EPS 2026 replaced **EPS-95**, effective **29 JUNE 2026** · **formula and contributions UNCHANGED** · **minimum pension still ₹1,000**, in force since **1 Sept 2014** — **NOT raised to ₹7,500** · **claims to be settled in 20 DAYS** · **12% interest penalty on the EPFO** for delay · the higher-pension sub-para omitted · higher pension option from the **Supreme Court judgment of 4 NOVEMBER 2022**

EPFO 3.0 UPI and ATM withdrawal · **auto-settlement raised to ₹5 LAKH** from ₹1 lakh · **up to 75%** withdrawable by UPI · **13 categories simplified to 3** · automatic transfer on changing jobs

ELI SCHEME outlay about **₹99,446 crore** · effective **1 AUGUST 2025** · **Part A: one month's EPF wage up to ₹15,000**, in **TWO instalments** after **6 and 12 months**, the second

conditional on a **financial literacy programme** · **eligibility salary up to ₹1 LAKH** · **Part B: up to ₹3,000 a month for two years** per additional employee

e-SHRAM about **31 crore** unorganised workers registered, about **3.37 lakh** platform workers — set against the EPFO's **7 crore** contributing members

THE SIX ECONOMY FACTS MOST LIKELY TO APPEAR **GST two slabs 5% and 18%** (22 Sept 2025) · **Income-tax Act 2025** in force **1 April 2026** · **GDP base year 2022-23** · **16th Finance Commission, Panagariya, 2026–31, 41%** · **fertility below replacement** · **Census 2027 first digital, caste included, reference date 1 March 2027**

OTHER READINGS repo **5.25%** · fiscal deficit **4.3%** · GDP growth **7.4% (FAE)** · CPI about **2.1%** · unemployment about **5.1%**, LFPR about **54–55%** · **PLFS now MONTHLY**

THE ROUND NUMBERS, WITH THEIR UNITS **PM-JAY ₹5 lakh per FAMILY per YEAR** · **PMJJBY ₹2 lakh life** · **PMSBY ₹2 lakh accident** · **APY ₹1,000–5,000 MONTHLY pension** · **minimum EPS pension ₹1,000 monthly** · **EPFO auto-settlement ₹5 lakh THRESHOLD** · **₹15,000 = EPF ceiling AND the ELI benefit cap**

8. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F10.2

4 CODES · 29 ACTS · IN FORCE 21 NOVEMBER 2025

WAGES 2019. THE OTHER THREE 2020

THE EPF ACT 1952 SITS INSIDE THE CODE ON SOCIAL SECURITY 2020

ID ACT » IR CODE · FACTORIES ACT » OSH CODE

UNIFORM DEFINITION OF "WAGES" ACROSS ALL FOUR

AGGREGATOR: 1–2% OF TURNOVER, CAP 5% OF WHAT IT PAYS WORKERS

45 DAYS TO REGISTER · 12% ON DELAY · 90 DAYS ONE, 120 DAYS MANY

EPF INTEREST 8.25% FOR 2025-26 — CBT RECOMMENDS, GOVERNMENT RATIFIES

CEILING IS STILL ₹15,000. ₹25,000 IS A PROPOSAL, NOT NOTIFIED

PROPOSED is not APPROVED is not NOTIFIED. ONLY NOTIFIED IS LAW

MANDATORY CONTRIBUTION ₹1,800. ABOVE IT IS VOLUNTARY

EPS 2026 REPLACED EPS-95 ON 29 JUNE 2026

MINIMUM PENSION STILL ₹1,000, NOT ₹7,500

20-DAY SETTLEMENT · 12% PENALTY ON THE EPFO

HIGHER PENSION: SUPREME COURT, 4 NOVEMBER 2022

EPFO 3.0: ₹5 LAKH AUTO-SETTLEMENT · 75% BY UPI · 13 CATEGORIES TO 3

ELI: ₹99,446 CRORE · 1 AUG 2025 · ₹15,000 IN TWO PARTS · SALARY UP TO ₹1 LAKH

e-SHRAM 31 CRORE vs EPFO 7 CRORE — THAT IS THE COVERAGE GAP

GST 5 AND 18 · INCOME-TAX ACT 2025 · BASE YEAR 2022-23 · 41% · TFR BELOW 2.1 · CENSUS 1 MARCH 2027

LEARN SCHEME + AMOUNT + UNIT. THE UNIT IS USUALLY THE DISCRIMINATOR

ONE LINE FOR THE INTERVIEW The most consequential recent change for this organisation is not the interest rate but the coverage question: e-Shram records roughly thirty-one crore unorganised workers against about seven crore contributing provident fund members, and the Code on Social Security's turnover-based levy on aggregators is the first serious attempt to bridge that gap without an employer to contribute.

ACTION · MODULE 10 IS COMPLETE

Two chapters — **F10.1 the system and the watchlist, F10.2 the dossier** — covering **20.0 planning marks**.

Next: Module 11 — PYQ Analysis, Mocks and Final Revision. It is the last module and the only one that acts on everything already covered rather than adding to it.

Before you leave Module 10, do two things. **Diarise the F10.1 §4 sweep** for the fortnight before your paper. And **start the monthly sheet tonight**, per F10.1 §3.2 — the system is worth more than this dossier, because the dossier expires and the system does not.